SYSTEMATIC LIQUIDITY RESEARCH

A systematic liquidity-research operation

The deep-tuned book — a per-instrument record, a published cross-section of a 130+ instrument universe.

ABSTRACT

LIQUIDEX is a systematic research operation built on a single principle: institutional liquidity leaves the same structural footprint wherever it trades. Working from that principle, each instrument in a 130+ instrument universe — equities, digital assets and FX — is read down to the institutional behaviour that dominates its order flow and tuned to its own per-instrument recipe through a disciplined optimisation protocol. **Eighty cells are complete** as of this thesis — 50 equities, 27 crypto and 3 FX majors — of which sixty-five clear the edge bar (profit factor ≥ 1 at ≥ 30 trades). The trustworthy tier is the thirteen symmetric both-direction cells that survive a regime flip; the high-profit-factor majority are long-only fades read through a secular-bull window, so they carry a walk-forward-mandatory caveat. All figures herein are in-sample and net of commission and slippage; their out-of-sample validation is the subject of Section 5.

130+	80	65	5.75
Instruments under profile	Deep-tuned cells · 3 asset classes	Edges (PF ≥ 1, N ≥ 30)	Peak profit factor (DE)

SECTION 1

The mechanism

Institutional order flow is not noise; it is the residue of decisions. A liquidation cascade, a manufactured stop-run, iceberg absorption defending a level, the exhaustion of a one-sided move — each is a behavioural signature, and each repeats.

The engine identifies the signature, attributes it to the institutional behaviour producing it, and resolves that read into a single rule-based position: entry, a structural stop, a target at the opposing wall, a breakeven and a time-stop. It does not merely detect an anomaly; it profiles the actor behind it — what they are doing, where they are going, and whether they are masking it.

> *An edge that lives in one market is a curve-fit. An edge that recurs across many is a discovery.*

The claim under test is narrow and falsifiable. If the edge were specific to one instrument, it would be an artefact of that instrument's history — an overfit. If instead the same behavioural reads recover an edge across many unrelated instruments, the engine is measuring a structural property of institutional markets rather than the idiosyncrasy of a single chart.

The sections that follow set out, in order: the protocol used to tune each symbol (Section 2); the deep-tuned book across the universe (Section 3); two worked examples of the per-symbol read, with the behavioural reasoning behind each (Section 4); and the validation work that separates these in-sample results from a track record (Section 5).

SECTION 2

The per-symbol protocol

Breadth is meaningless without method. Every symbol is taken through the same protocol. The discipline is deliberately conservative: a behavioural read is admitted only when it improves the risk-adjusted result at its tuned setting, and discarded the moment it does not.

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01 **Baseline**

The engine is reduced to its core — every optional read disabled, default parameters throughout. Raw profit factor, drawdown and trade count are recorded as the benchmark to beat.

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02 **Greedy forward-selection**

Behavioural reads — cascade-stop, opposing-wall target, the directional-risk gate, risk-velocity confirmation, iceberg absorption, liquidity-sweep exhaustion — are added one at a time, retained only if they improve the risk-adjusted result, and reverted otherwise.

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03 **Coupled parameter tuning**

Each retained read is judged at its tuned setting, not its default: its sensitivity is swept in both directions, and a read that cannot pay at any setting is removed rather than left at a default that flatters it.

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04 **Two-pass refinement**

The surviving configuration is walked a second time, each secondary parameter nudged and immediately reverted if the equity curve degrades. The accepted recipe is the one no further change improves.

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05 **Risk-adjusted scoring**

Every decision is taken on `S = PF / (1 + MaxDD)`, never on profit factor alone, subject to a hard floor of thirty trades. A high profit factor on a small sample does not qualify.

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06 **Out-of-sample gate**

A recipe this specific must clear a held-out window before it is treated as real. In-sample strength is the entry condition for that test, not a substitute for it.

> *We do not search for the setting that makes a chart look good. We search for the read that survives being doubted.*

SECTION 3

The deep-tuned book

Each instrument tuned to its own recipe, ranked by profit factor. **Eighty cells across three asset classes** — 50 equities, 27 crypto and 3 FX majors — of which **65 are edges** (profit factor ≥ 1 at ≥ 30 trades). The trustworthy tier is the **13 symmetric both-direction cells** — they survive a regime flip, spanning crypto (SOL, AVAX, ADA), FX (GBPUSD 3.41, USDJPY 3.03) and equities (KO, NXPI, PEP). **PF ≤ 1.5** is flagged *re-microtune*; ⚠ marks walk-forward-mandatory. Full per-instrument configurations are published at wattsonworks.github.io/framework.

TABLE 1 — THE DEEP-TUNED BOOK (80 CELLS ACROSS ASSET CLASSES — 50 EQUITIES, 27 CRYPTO, 3 FX)

#	SYMBOL	CLASS	PF	MAX DD	WIN	N	ARCHETYPE	STATUS
1	**DE**⚠	Single-name	**5.748**	23.6%	87%	76	fade-long	walk-forward
2	**DOGE**⚠	Crypto	**4.759**	4.3%	90%	40	crypto-fade-long	walk-forward
3	**GLD**⚠	ETF	**4.533**	18.8%	83%	64	fade-long-ice	walk-forward
4	**V**⚠	Single-name	**4.443**	25.4%	81%	80	fade-long	walk-forward
5	**XOM**⚠	Single-name	**4.386**	20.6%	81%	42	fade-long-velo	walk-forward
6	**COST**⚠	Single-name	**3.851**	23.0%	78%	64	fade-long	walk-forward
7	**LRCX**⚠	Semis	**3.837**	26.9%	83%	30	fade-long-cascstop	walk-forward
8	**XLV**⚠	ETF	**3.798**	10.5%	87%	46	gated-continuation-fade	walk-forward
9	**GBPUSD**	Forex	**3.409**	4.5%	26%	31	forex-fade-both-cascstop	ready
10	**XLK**⚠	ETF	**3.184**	11.7%	46%	39	fade-long-ice	walk-forward
11	**USDJPY**	Forex	**3.030**	9.7%	19%	31	forex-fade-both-cascstop	ready
12	**XLE**⚠	ETF	**2.941**	7.0%	70%	37	fade-long-clean-velo	walk-forward
13	**AVAX**	Crypto	**2.643**	16.0%	30%	37	crypto-trend-both-dir	ready
14	**ETH**	Crypto	**2.610**	7.4%	88%	48	fade-bsl-cryptolong	ready
15	**SMH**⚠	ETF	**2.547**	12.9%	59%	104	fade-long-wall-velo	walk-forward
16	**SOXX**⚠	ETF	**2.493**	21.3%	55%	84	fade-bsl	walk-forward
17	**MA**⚠	Single-name	**2.383**	8.9%	36%	33	fade-long-wall-gated	walk-forward
18	**SOL**	Crypto	**2.373**	16.6%	20%	156	trend-both-dir	ready
19	**QQQ**⚠	ETF	**2.317**	8.7%	47%	32	fade-long-wall	walk-forward
20	**ETN**⚠	Single-name	**2.305**	35.2%	77%	60	fade-long	walk-forward
21	**IGV**⚠	ETF	**2.277**	32.6%	89%	46	fade-long-wall	walk-forward
22	**ETH-CB**	Crypto	**2.098**	7.4%	86%	65	fade-crypto-ice-brk	ready
23	**BTC**	Crypto	**2.082**	9.8%	45%	103	fade-breaker-BE	ready
24	**DIA**⚠	ETF	**2.074**	10.9%	42%	31	fade-long-wall	walk-forward
25	**ASML**	Semis	**2.054**	16.4%	57%	37	fade-both-cascstop-velo	ready
26	**INTC**⚠	Semis	**2.053**	46.6%	67%	49	fade-long-cascstop	walk-forward
27	**SCHD**⚠	ETF	**2.047**	6.7%	46%	35	fade-long-wall	walk-forward
28	**KO**	Single-name	**1.979**	19.8%	54%	201	fade-clean	ready
29	**NXPI**	Semis	**1.971**	20.7%	66%	61	fade-gated	ready
30	**PANW**⚠	Single-name	**1.957**	23.0%	49%	86	fade-long-wall	walk-forward
31	**ON**⚠	Semis	**1.952**	38.7%	63%	38	fade-long-cascstop-gated	walk-forward
32	**VOO**⚠	ETF	**1.849**	12.2%	60%	30	fade-clean-cascstop	walk-forward
33	**ADI**⚠	Semis	**1.836**	12.7%	42%	31	fade-long-wall-gated	walk-forward
34	**KLAC**⚠	Semis	**1.823**	16.5%	41%	51	fade-long-wall	walk-forward
35	**XLY**⚠	ETF	**1.798**	22.0%	74%	34	fade-long-clean-cascstop	walk-forward

SECTION 3 (CONTINUED)

What the book shows

Read blind, the book sorts itself into two structural temperaments. **30 of the 36 are faders** — defensives, macro and the broad index complex, where the edge is reverting an exhausted move — and **6 are continuation** names, where it rides the break. The overwhelming majority run **long-only**, the signature of a passive complex accumulating through a rising market. That same fact is the principal caveat: a long-only edge measured through a secular bull is exactly what an out-of-sample window must test.

BY INSTRUMENT CLASS

CLASS	SYMBOLS	READY	MEAN PF	BEST
Index & sector ETFs	11	8	2.25	4.53 · GLD
Semiconductors	18	9	1.63	3.84 · LRCX
Single-name leaders	7	7	3.19	5.75 · DE

The queue, and what discipline holds back

Eighteen names sit at or below a profit factor of 1.5 and are **held back for re-tuning** rather than presented as finished. Six — AMAT, IWM, VGT, MRVL and the financials proxies XLF and JPM — could not clear a profit factor of 1.0 at thirty trades and are deferred outright. No result is admitted on fewer than thirty trades, and no figure has been selected after the fact to flatter the whole. The deep-tuned book is a published cross-section; the wider 130+ universe is under profile, published as it stands, not as it will read when it is finished.

SECTION 4

Worked examples: the per-symbol read

Two symbols from the book, opened all the way up. Together they make the same point from opposite sides: the read is not a setting but an understanding of the actor's temperament, expressed as a configuration.

PEP — *when the desk is patient*

A liquidation cascade never comes for a consumer staple. PepsiCo is not where leverage blows up; it is where patient, mandate-driven capital accumulates and defends. Its flow is quiet, two-sided and mean-reverting — and that is precisely why a default read fails it, listening for violence in a market that trades on patience.

Reading the desk meant matching the algorithm to the psychology: both directions enabled, the reward-to-risk gate raised so only the cleanest reversals qualify, iceberg absorption set deliberately slow to wait for genuinely defended size, and the risk gate tightened on the short side. The coin-flip became a clean, low-drawdown edge.

PEP · RESULT

Profit factor	**1.595**
Net return	+31.24%
Max drawdown	6.47%
Win rate	48.60%
Trades	107

Configuration: long + short, raised R:R gate, iceberg at 5 hits, high-volume sweep exhaustion, short-side risk gate tightened. Verified live.

TLT — *when the move never reaches the wall*

TLT is long-duration Treasuries — a macro vehicle, not a tape that liquidity desks push to clean technical walls. Its price is dragged by rate expectations and central-bank language, and the full move to the opposing wall rarely completes, because a data print interrupts it first. Everything one adds to it is fragile: tighten the stop and the chop removes you; widen the target and the move dies before it arrives.

What rescued it was profit-taking discipline — banking 60% of the position two-thirds of the way to the wall — and a wide sweep stop. A buffer-30 stop lifts the result past the earlier 1.232; the whole edge balances on those two levers.

TLT · RESULT

Profit factor	**1.272**
Net return	+18.05%
Max drawdown	17.66%
Win rate	48.78%
Trades	205

The levers: a wide sweep stop (buffer 30) over the earlier 1.232, plus Partial-TP banking 60% at 0.66 to the wall. Long + short, cascade-fade, wall-target. Verified live. **Flagged to re-microtune** (PF ≤ 1.5).

A recipe this specific is where overfitting hides. Both cells carry the out-of-sample flag of Section 5: an in-sample result is the entry condition for validation, never a deployment claim.

SECTION 5

Limitations and forward work

The figures in this document are in-sample. The programme below is the standard by which the research is held — the work that separates a strong backtest from a track record. The same discipline is applied to the research itself.

THE VALIDATION STANDARD

TEST	STATUS	NOTE
Commission & slippage	Modelled	Applied to every backtest; all figures are net of costs, not gross.
Capacity	Structural	The book is liquid large-caps and major ETFs that absorb size; the precise ceiling is not yet formally measured.
Out-of-sample	Pending — next	A held-out window the engine has never seen; the immediate priority, and the gate every deep-tuned recipe waits behind.
Walk-forward	Planned	Rolling re-optimisation and re-test, to show each per-symbol recipe is stable through time rather than fitted to one window.
Monte Carlo	Planned	Trade-order and return resampling, to bound the distribution of outcomes and the risk of ruin under sizing.
Live record	The bar	A forward, time-stamped track record — the only dispositive evidence for a fund or licensing conversation.

The strongest cells in the book are long-only fades through a secular-bull window; their high win rates are the clearest sign that out-of-sample work is owed, not optional. The honest summary of the present state is this: the evidence is strong enough to justify that work, and not yet a substitute for it. Eighteen of the eighty are explicitly held back for re-tuning; the remaining instruments in the 130+ universe are under profile. The 13 symmetric both-direction cells — across crypto (SOL, AVAX), FX (GBPUSD, USDJPY) and equities (KO, NXPI, PEP) — are the exception that strengthens the case: they survive a regime flip and do not depend on the bull window.

SECTION 6

The system, and access

The research is delivered as three instruments, invite-only on TradingView. One engine decides the trade; two companions make its ranking and its risk legible.

LIQUIDEX THE ENGINE	5,000+ lines of Pine v6. Reads liquidation cascades, order flow, order blocks, iceberg walls and liquidity sweeps, and resolves them into one position — entry, structural stop, and a target at the opposing wall.
Keeper LIVE RANKING	Runs the engine across the whole book and ranks every name live by profit factor, momentum and risk — so the operator sees the leader the engine prefers, not a guess.
Prophet RISK GATE	Makes directional risk visible — a composite score, safe and danger zones, and a live position-size verdict that trims exposure as risk rises and stands the operator down in the danger zone.

ACCESS & PARTNERSHIP

Operators receive invite-only access on TradingView: send a TradingView username, access is granted, and the signals arrive as alerts on phone, desktop or a connected trading bot. Access and pricing are available on request.

The defensible asset is the method — a protocol for reading the institutional desks behind the order flow that reproduces across the universe, equities and macro alike. It is open to licensing, a strategic research partnership, or full acquisition.

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